



E-Commerce Portal for Aura Boutique

SUBJECT NAME: Web Development (Introduction)

SUBJECT CODE: WEDE5020

ASSESSMENT TYPE: PoE- Part 2: Building the Foundation

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Group: 03

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Proposal Content:

If the storyline is fictional, you would still be required to present realistic content for the fictional client.

- ❖ **1. Organisation Overview:** Name: [Organisation Name]
- ❖ Provide a brief history of the organisation.
- ❖ Mission and vision statements.
- ❖ Target audience.

2. Website Goals and Objectives:

- ❖ Define specific goals for the website (e.g., increase website traffic, generate leads, sell products, or provide valuable information).
- ❖ Determine and present key performance indicators (KPIs) to measure success.

3. Current Website Analysis (if applicable):

- Analyse strengths and weaknesses of the existing website.
- Identify areas for improvement based on the weaknesses identified.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality:

- Outline essential features (e.g., homepage, about us, contact page, products/services page) and the desired functionality.

5. Design and User Experience:

- Discuss the overall design aesthetic and branding, highlighting the following:
 - Colour Scheme: [Proposed Colour Palette]
 - Typography: [Font Choices and Hierarchy]
 - Layout and Design: [Overall Design Approach]
- User experience considerations (e.g., navigation, layout, colour scheme).

- Develop low-fidelity wireframes to visualise the website's layout and information hierarchy.

6. Technical Requirements:

- Identify hosting and domain name requirements and programming languages and frameworks (e.g., HTML, CSS, JavaScript).

7. Timeline and Milestones:

- Create a realistic project timeline with key milestones that follow the timeline during the subject's submission dates.

8. Budget:

- Estimate the budget for development, hosting, and maintenance (while this is a series of assignments, the budget should reflect realistic amounts based on your research).

9. References:

- References listed here are unique to the chosen organisation and the researched documentation of the Website Project Proposal. The references listed in this document and the general references used to complete Part 1 will be compiled in the README.md document in the repository for the entire PoE.

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Organisation Overview

- Aura Boutique
- Founded in 2021, Aura Boutique is an upscale brick-and-mortar clothing storefront operating in Durban, South Africa. The boutique specializes in curating high-quality, locally designed contemporary fashion and sustainable apparel.
- Its Mission and Vision are to provide South African consumers with locally sourced, ethically manufactured designer garments that combine premium luxury aesthetics with sustainable daily wear.
- The Target Audience is primarily focused on fashion-conscious individuals aged 22-45, trend-focused urban professionals, and online consumers seeking ethical boutique goods.

Website Goals and Objectives

- To move from an offline boutique to a high-performing omnichannel retailer, the platform will target the following highly aggressive, quantifiable metrics within its initial six months post-launch:
 1. Digital Scale: Broden retail reach from KZN to a nationwide digital marketplace.
 2. Active User Base (MAUs): Achieve plus minus 5,000 monthly active users.
 3. Conversion Rate: Covert plus minus 2.5% of unique visitors into completed sales transactions.
 4. Lead Generation: Build a subscriber list of plus minus 1,200 leads via optimized inbound capture paths.
- Objective 1: Market expansion & scalability
 - Shift brand positioning from a localized Durban storefront to a prominent national fashion contender.
 - Supported by a robust cloud hosting infrastructure and SEO optimization targeting premium apparel keywords across South Africa.
- Objective 2: Aggressive traffic acquisition & engagement
 - Secure 5,000+ verified MAUs by month six through aggressive social media integration, content-driven fashion blogging, and structured email newsletter campaigns.
- Object 3: Optimized digital conversion funnel
 - Maintain a 2.5% transaction conversion rate by minimising user friction at every point of the digital shopping experience.
- Objective 4: High-value customer retention & lifetime value (LTV)
 - Capture 1,200 qualified email subscribers within the first six months to build a high-utility asset for zero-cost remarketing.
 - Incentivized by a elegant, non-intrusive footer capture form and exit-intent modals offering exclusive early access to seasonal lookbooks.

Current Website Analysis

- Aura Boutique currently relies entirely on offline retail interactions and casual social media showcasing on Instagram. There is no existing functional web deployment, e-commerce storefront or formal digital inventory tracking database. This operational model introduces several severe weaknesses:
 1. The complete lack of digital transaction tooling creates absolute dependency on physical foot traffic and manual communication channels.
 2. The businesses discovery and sales drop to zero immediately outside of physical retail operating hours.
 3. Inventory reporting is highly prone to human error due to the total lack of an automated system.
 4. The lack of digital payment checkout points entirely prevents the boutique from capturing lucrative non-local provincial payment .
- Aura Boutique would want to establish a continuous 24/7 digital presence, automate cross-channel inventory management via a centralized digital database, and implement secure, localized national payment gateways.

Proposed Website Features and Functionality

- The platform features an advanced, comprehensive suite of customized utilities designed to deliver a high converting, luxury e-commerce experience:
 1. Dynamic interactive landing page
 - A premium visual entrance showcasing fluid, high-definition seasonal lookbooks and curated product lines.
 - Built with clean primary navigation menus, dynamic hero sliders, and explicit call-to-action (CTA) buttons (“Shop the Collection”) that guide users straight to seasonal inventory.
 2. Interactive Multi-column collectional grid
 - A flexible product catalog featuring real-time, zero-latency text search and a multi-tiered taxonomy category filtering system (.eg.,Size, Colour, Price, Material, Sustainability index).
 - Provides rapid product exploration with instant asynchronous “Add chart” capabilities, clear pricing matrices, and visual colour swatches.
 3. User-accessible slide-out shopping drawer
 - A modern, space-efficient shopping cart that slides out from the right viewport boundary without forcing a page reload.
 - Displays real-time quantity modifiers, itemised subtotal updates, dynamic shipping estimators, localised payment badge indicators, and transparent tax calculations.
 4. Integrated Multi-tiered product information engine.
 - Comprehensive single-product pages featuring interactive image galleries with deep zoom capability, collapsible accordions for product provenance and ethical sourcing data, and dynamic sizing guides.
 5. Automated Real-time inventory synced database
 - A secure backend database architecture that connects live stock quantities to the front-end user interface.
 - Automatically flags products as “Low stock” or “Out of stock”, instantly preventing the over-purchase of limited designer pieces

Design and User Experience

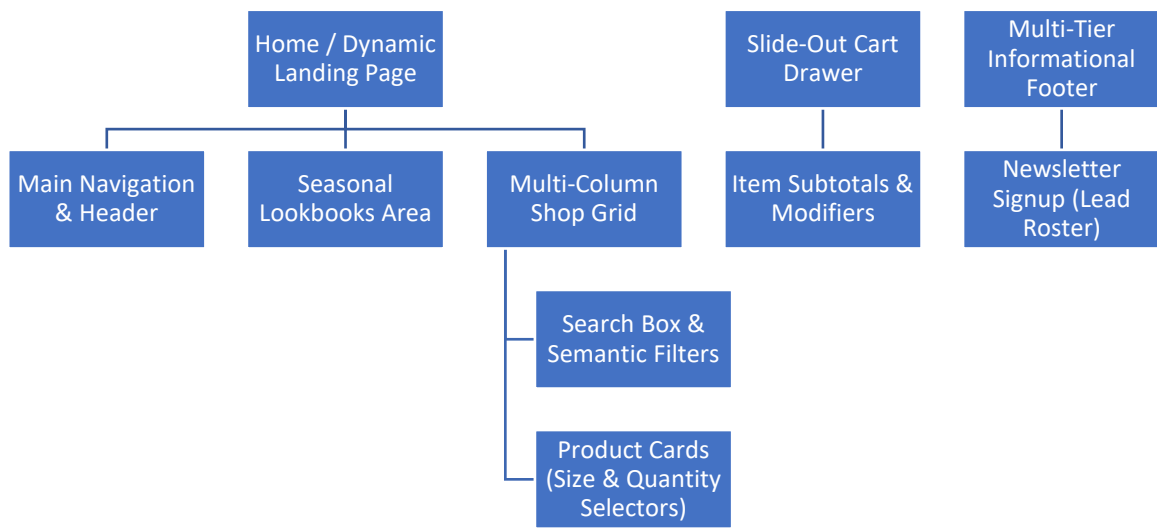
- The user experience (UX) layout focuses on a minimalist luxury editorial aesthetic, engineered specifically to emphasise garment imagery and elevate perceived product value.

Colour Palette Matrix

- Charcoal (#1A1A1A)
 - Typography structural boundaries, primary text headers.
- Ivory Soft (#F8F8FA)
 - Soft background surfaces, minimising eye strain.
- Warm Champagne (#D4F37)
 - High-contrast highlights, active states, key CTA accents.

Typography Hierarchy

- Primary display headers
 - Aptos display (14pt, Bold). Clean, authoritative architectural structure.
- Body & Informational text
 - Aptos text (11pt, Regular). Highly readable, optimised for fluid paragraph lines across mobile and desktop viewports.
- Adhere to intuitive user pathways, including standard top anchored sticky navigation utility headers, predictable right-aligned interactive shopping carts, and a structured multi-tiered informational footer.
- [Wireframe Placeholder: Embedded low-fidelity wireframes block highlighting structurally responsive grid structures for Desktop and Mobile viewpoints].



- index
- about
- products
- galley
- enquiry
- contact

Technical Requirements

- Domain booking requirements require registration of an active localized URL asset e.g. (auraboutique.co.za).
- Hosting setup utilizes scalable cloud environments.
- Frontend user layers are structured utilizing clean Semantic HTML5 markers for accessibility compliance, alongside responsive layout mechanics handled through CSS Grid layouts.
- Client-side interactivity is written in native JavaScript to manage shopping cart adjustments, catalog sorting filters, dynamic form validations, and asynchronous calls.

Timeline and Milestones

- This schedule guarantees an organized, transparent development cycle leading to a successful launch within 10 weeks:

Phase 1: Weeks 1-2 – Discovery, asset finalisation and wireframing

- Finalise complete structural layout maps and clear user path configurations
- Collect and catalogue brand assets, high-definition product imagery, and copy.
- Deliver finalized low-fidelity and high-fidelity UI wireframes for mobile and desktop viewports.
- Deliverable after approved UI/UX design blueprint and signed scope document.

Phase 2: Weeks 3-5- Structural frameworks & front-end composition

- Write responsive, accessible HTML5 semantic structural frameworks.
- Build the responsive design system using modular CSS Grid layouts
- Incorporate fluid layout transitions and luxury typography hierarchies.
- Deliverable after complete static front-end layout prototype (Responsive templates).

Phase 3: Weeks 6-8- Functional programming & database integration

- Write client-side native JavaScript scripts for interactive storefront elements.
- Build the asynchronous catalog searching, filtering, and real-time sorting mechanics.
- Program the cart drawer states, quantity calculation validations, and database stock synchronisation rules.
- Deliverable fully after functional interactivity is enabled through core staging rules.

Phase 4: Weeks 9-10- Deployment, security verification & launch

- Connect localized domain assets to production hosting environments
- Run intensive end-to-end checkout path testing and implement secure payment gateway configurations.
- Complete performance optimization passes, browser compatibility checks, and SEO visibility testing.
- Deliverable: Live, fully operational E-Commerce platform deployment.

Budget

- Domain Registration (.co.za): R150 (Annual renewal fee)
- Cloud Hosting Platform: R300 / month (Scalable base package)
- E-Commerce Portal Integration: R250 / month (Gateway transaction tools)
- The Estimated Development and Maintenance Allocation: R15,000 (One-time asset creation framework budget)

References

- (Flanagan, 2020)
- (Marcotte, 2011)
- (South African Bureau of Standards, 2021)
- (World Wide Web Consortium, 2023)
- (World Wide Web Consortium, 2024)